Jaehong Kim

Ph.D. Candidate at KAIST (Expected Graduation: February 2027)
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study how moral emotions shape **human and machine behavior**. I build **multimodal frameworks** that detect moral emotions in English and Korean text and images, and find that **moral outrage** (anger at perceived wrongdoing) most strongly predicts committed user participation and is disproportionately used by suspected **foreign-linked trolls**. In **large language models (LLMs)**, I show that steering internal representations of moral outrage causally shifts punishment judgments, leading models to recommend harsher sentences for identical offenses.
Beyond academia, my research on foreign-linked influence operations has received **national media coverage**, including an SBS News report with over 1.2 million views, and has **contributed to policy discussions** among lawmakers.

EDUCATION

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST) — Daejeon, Korea
Ph.D., Graduate School of Culture Technology, Social Computing Lab (Advisor: Wonjae Lee) — 2023.08 - Present
Dissertation: How Moral Outrage Shapes Human and Machine Behavior

M.S., Graduate School of Culture Technology, Social Computing Lab (Advisor: Wonjae Lee) — 2021.08 - 2023.08
Thesis: How moral emotions shape the commitment of political support in the online petition

Handong Global University — Pohang, Korea
B.A., Communication, Psychology, ICT Convergence (Minor), Cum Laude — 2015.03 - 2021.08

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications (* denotes co-first authorship, † denotes international collaboration)

- **J. Kim***, H. Kim*, J. Kim, A. Oh, T. Holz, W. Lee, M. Cha. (2026). Cross-National Information Attacks: A Two-Decade Analysis of Troll Behavior in Korea. *In Proc. of the 35th USENIX Security Symposium* (USENIX Security '26). [Zenodo] †
- S. Park*, **J. Kim***, H. Kim, H. Bin, S. Moon, W. Lee. (2026). Moral Outrage Shapes Commitments Beyond Attention: Multimodal Moral Emotions on YouTube in Korea and the US. *In Proc. of The Web Conference* (WWW 2026). [GitHub] †
- M. Sundriyal*, **J. Kim***, W. Dong, W. Lee, M. Cha. (2026). Nothing to Dread: A Measurement Study of a Dark Web Social Forum. *In Proc. of the 2026 ACM Internet Measurement Conference* (IMC '26). [Zenodo] †
- W. Dong*, M. Sundriyal*, S. Park*, **J. Kim***, M. Cha, T. Chakraborty, W. Lee. (2025). Parallel Communities Across the Surface Web and the Dark Web. *In Findings of Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing* (EMNLP Findings 2025). *Nominated for Best Resource Paper.* [Zenodo] †
- **J. Kim***, C. Jeong*, S. Park*, M. Cha, W. Lee. (2024). How Do Moral Emotions Shape Political Participation? A Cross-Cultural Analysis of Online Petitions Using Language Models. *In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics* (ACL Findings 2024). [GitHub] †
- J. Kim, J. Kwon, L. F. Vecchietti, W. Dong, **J. Kim**, M. Cha. (2026). Machine Behavior in Relational Moral Dilemmas: Moral Rightness, Predicted Human Behavior, and Model Decisions. *In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics* (ACL Findings 2026). [GitHub] †

Under Review & Working Papers

- **J. Kim**, J. Kim, H. Kim, J. Kwon, M. Cha, W. Lee. (2026). Investigating the Causal Role of Internal Moral Outrage in LLM Punishment Judgments. *Under review at ICLR 2027.* †
- **J. Kim**, S. Park, W. Dong, A. Zhunis, M. Cha, W. Lee. From Online Outrage to Offline Protest: Evidence from the Israel-Palestine and Russia-Ukraine Conflicts. *Working paper.* †

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy (MPI-SP) Bochum, Germany
Research Intern, Data Science for Humanity (Advisor: Meeyoung Cha) 2025.09 - 2026.02
Research Intern, Data Science for Humanity (Advisor: Meeyoung Cha) 2024.09 - 2024.11

INTERNATIONAL COLLABORATIONS

Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy (MPI-SP) 2024-Present

Data Science for Humanity Group (Prof. Meeyoung Cha); research on influence operations and dark web social media analysis

Mohamed bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence (MBZUAI) 2025-Present

Department of NLP (Prof. Alham Fikri Aji); explainable classification of moral emotions

INVITED TALKS

NYU Center for Conflict and Cooperation 2026

Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy, Data Science for Humanity Group 2026

Reichman University, AI/NLP Seminar 2026

Korea Computer Congress Top Conference Session 2026

Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy, Workshop on the Societal Impact of AI Systems 2025

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

KAIST Fake News Challenge *Best Prize (KRW 2,000,000)* 2026

Global Advanced Human Resource Development Program in Information Security, IITP *Competitive national fellowship; funded research visit to MPI-SP (KRW 18,000,000)* 2025

Hyundai Motor Chung Mong-Koo Global Scholarship *(KRW 28,000,000)* 2025

Adventure Research Program, KAIST *(KRW 1,000,000)* 2024

Young-Han Kim Global Leader Scholarship, KAIST *(KRW 4,000,000)* 2023

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Natural Language Processing for the Humanities and Social Sciences (HSS510) 2025.03 – 2025.06
Led lab sessions on LLM fine-tuning, covering core concepts and hands-on implementation

Social Network Analysis (CTP471) 2024.03 – 2024.06
Assisted student projects on network theory and analysis in R, providing feedback and technical support

Social Computing (GCT576) 2023.09 – 2023.12
Mentored student research applying core sociological concepts to computational social science

Computational Social Science (HSS312), Selected as Best TA 2021.09 – 2021.12
Led coding tutorials on data collection methods (e.g., web scraping, APIs)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Panelist: Global South ML Workshop at ICML 2026 / **Reviewer**: ICLR 2027, CSCW 2025 / **Shared Task Organizer**: FinNLP-FNP-LLMFinLegal 2024